documents depend on access to the document IDs. These are the operations we cover in this section:

- Getting a single document, given an ID
- Getting multiple documents, given a set of IDs
- Getting all the documents at once (no IDs, no search criteria)

We can fetch a single document from Elasticsearch by invoking a document API call given an ID, and we can use another API query (`ids`) to fetch multiple documents. We also go over using the `_search` API to retrieve all the documents at once.

RETRIEVING A SINGLE DOCUMENT

Similar to fetching a record from a database using a primary key, retrieving the document from Elasticsearch is straightforward, as long as we have the document's ID. To do that, we issue a `GET` command in the Kibana console with the API URL and document ID. The generic format for retrieving the documents with an identifier is `GET <index>/_doc/<id>`. To retrieve a single document, issue a `GET` command, providing the ID `1`.

Listing 2.4 Retrieving an individual document by its ID

```
GET books/_doc/1
```

If this command is executed successfully, you will see a response on the right-hand side of the code editor, as shown in figure 2.10.

The response contains two pieces of information: the original document, under the `_source` tag, and the metadata of this document (such as `index`, `id`, `found`,

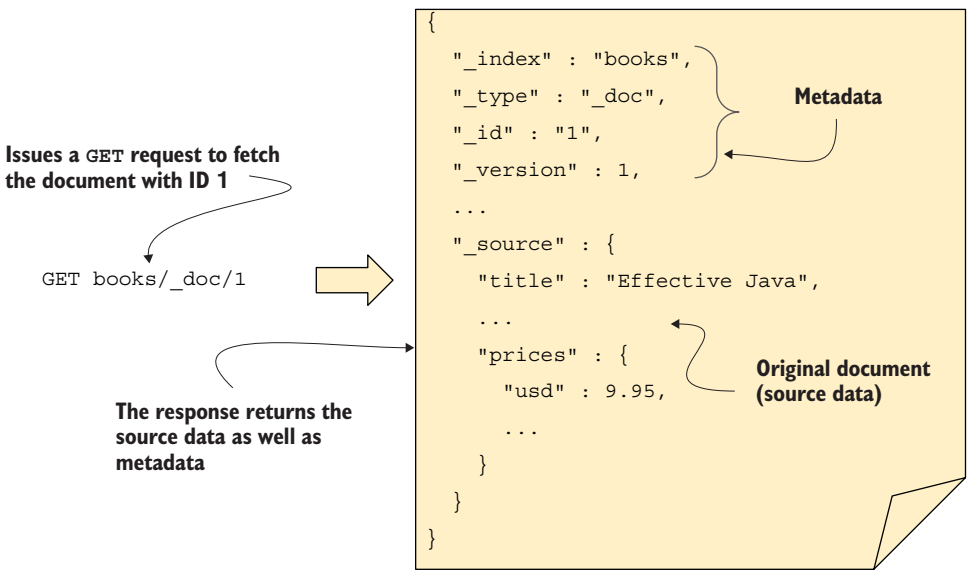


Figure 2.10 Fetching a `book` document by ID